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LEADER IN ADAPTIVE PREPARATION FOR CAT

AIRCAT-2509 Dissection

AIRCAT2409 was a relatively tough test as the percentage of relatively easy questions was lower than usual in all the 3 sections, and hence, it made for a tougher test overall. However, given your experience and exposure of previous few AIRCATs most of you would have managed it much better than you would have adapted to a similarly difficult test even a few weeks ago.

The test is again a re-iteration of the fact that you can't go in with a fixed notion about the number of attempts or marks needed to clear the cut-off levels in a section/overall.

Let us now look at a detailed sectional analysis in terms of (relative) difficulty level:

	Easy	Intermediate	Difficult	Difficulty Level	Cut off Questions (Marks)
Section I (VRC)	6	11	7	Difficult	14 (26)
Section II (DILR)	1	11	8	Difficult	12 (23)
Section III (QA)	7	10	5	Difficult	8 (14)
Overall	14	32	20	Difficult	34 (65)

English was dominated by RC, as has been the recent trend in CAT. None of the first 2 RC passages were easy in terms of either the content or the questions. And that usually causes a lot of time getting wasted in moving from one passage to another. The important thing here is that a tough test is tough for everyone, and generally, everyone would be making inefficient use of time on such a test. What made things tougher was the 6-question "Fudge" RC passage which had a few easy/intermediate questions, was largely fact-based, but was complex in terms of comprehension and assimilation. This passage was almost a necessity to do well in the section and even a 12-14 minute investment would have been well worth it, simply seeing the risk-return ratio. The only respite in VRC came towards the end in the non-MCQs that had a fair proportion of very doable questions. The para-jumbles especially were doable and must-attempts because they were essentially MCQs with no negative marking.

DILR was overall tough, with only the first set related to Media being the relatively easier, but not at an absolute level. Additionally, what happens in a tough section is that you leave a set thinking of it as tough, only to find tougher ones ahead. And jittery due to that timer just running away, you then pick out a set that's actually far tougher. Other than this set, the intermediate questions were interspersed across sets and therefore not easy to pick out. Taking up fewer questions and making them count is generally a better way to go in such scenarios – of a section or a test being tough. It is tough, but almost necessary in such cases, to pick out 1-2 easy questions from a set. So, for example,

30 and 34 were 2 relatively easier questions in the Challengers/Events set. Similarly, 41 and 42 (the 4 Cricket Captains set) were far easier than 43 and 44.

QA was the easiest of the sections, even if the numbers and cut-offs don't suggest so. The reason has less to do with CAT related skills and more to do with human behaviour – with the first two sections being tough, the carry over into the final section was that of a spontaneous "it is tough" mode. Things would have been very different for most if the QA section were to be the first section of the test instead. Some of you who were able to detach themselves from the bias of the first two sections would have cracked QA and shored up your overall scores drastically. There were enough simple questions to pick out and score off in this section. But given the overall context, and the first two sections, it is understandable how most of you would have underperformed with respect to your potential, in this section.

Remember, temperament plays a bigger role in tougher tests than it does in easier ones. Staying cool becomes one of the most important things to do when others are panicking – that's a huge relative advantage. Be prepared more varied challenges ahead.

Tentative sectional and overall benchmarks are given below:

	98%ile	**95%ile**	**90%ile**	**85%ile**
Section I (VRC)	34	28	24	21
Section II (DILR)	30	25	21	19
Section III (QA)	20	16	12	11
Overall	70	59	49	44

-AIRCAT Spinner Team (AST)